Ashley Ge Zhang

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(updated Nov 2026)

Education

09/2021 – 07/2027 **University of Michigan**
(expected) Ph.D. in Information Science
Ann Arbor, MI Advisors: Steve Oney
Committee: Yan Chen (Virginia Tech), Eytan Adar, Barbara Ericson, and Perry Samson

09/2016 – 07/2021 **Peking University**
Beijing, China B.S. in Intelligence Science

Professional Experience

09/2021 – present **School of Information, University of Michigan**
Ann Arbor, MI Graduate student and researcher

05/2024 – 08/2024 **Adobe, Research Scientist Intern**
San Jose, CA Mentored by Dr. Jane Hoffswell
Developed and evaluated "ConvoMap", a visualization tool for debugging. (C.8)

09/2020 – 05/2021 **Peking University**
Beijing, China Undergraduate student and researcher
Thesis advised by Prof. Tao Xie

07 /2020 – 02/2021 **University of Washington, Remote Visiting Student**
Seattle, WA Advised by Prof. Amy Zhang
Conducted study on a computational notebook interface for collaboration in data science.

09/2019 – 12/2019 **University of Washington, Visiting Student**
Seattle, WA Advised by Prof. Tim Althoff
Developed a tool to classify code snippets as different stages of data science pipelines. (J.2)

12/2018 – 05/2019 **Shannon AI, Intern**
Beijing, China Mentored by Dr. Jiwei Li

Publications

Labels:
🏆 *best paper award*
🎗 *honorable mention for best paper award*

Approximate acceptance rates:
UIST: 20%, CHI: 25%, VL/HCC: 30%, L@S: 23%, KDD: 15%

Heavily-reviewed Conference Papers (C) and Journal Manuscripts (J)

C.10 (PDF) **Ashley Ge Zhang**, Yan-Ru Jhou, Yinuo Yang, Shamita Rao, Maryam Arab, Yan Chen, Steve Oney (2026) Editrail: Understanding AI Usage by Visualizing Student-AI Interaction in Code. *ACM Symposium on User Interface Software and Technology (UIST)*, Detroit, MI, USA.

C.9 (PDF) **Ashley Ge Zhang**, Yan-Ru Jhou, Yinuo Yang, Shamita Rao, Maryam Arab, Yan Chen, Steve Oney (2026) CodeStream: Augmenting Timelines with Code Annotation for Navigating Large Coding Histories. *ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)*, Barcelona, Spain.

C.8 (PDF) **Ashley Ge Zhang**, Victor Soares Bursztyn, Gromit Chan, Shunan Guo, Eunyee Koh, Steve Oney, Jane Hoffswell (2025) ConvoMap: Interactive Visualizations for Exploring Complex Conversations in Multi-Agent Systems. *IEEE Symposium on Visual Languages and Human-Centric Computing (VL/HCC)*, Raleigh, NC, USA.

🎗 C.7 (PDF) Yinuo Yang, **Ashley Ge Zhang**, Steve Oney, April Yi Wang (2025) SPARK: Real-Time Monitoring of Multi-Faceted Programming Exercises. *IEEE Symposium on Visual Languages and Human-Centric Computing (VL/HCC)*, Raleigh, NC, USA. **Honorable Mention Award**

🏆 C.6 (PDF) **Ashley Ge Zhang**, Xiaohang Tang, Steve Oney, Yan Chen (2024) CFlow: Supporting Semantic Flow Analysis of Students' Code in Programming Problems at Scale. *ACM Conference on Learning at Scale (L@S)*, Atlanta, GA, USA. **Best Paper Award**

C.5 (PDF) **Ashley Ge Zhang**, Yan Chen, Steve Oney (2023) RunEx: Augmenting Regular-Expression Code Search with Runtime Values. *IEEE Symposium on Visual Languages and Human-Centric Computing (VL/HCC)*, Washington, D.C., USA.

🎗 C.4 (PDF) **Ashley Ge Zhang**, Yan Chen, Steve Oney (2023) VizProg: Identifying Misunderstandings by Visualizing Students' Coding Progress. *ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)*, Hamburg, Germany. **Honorable Mention Award**

🎗 C.3 (PDF) April Yi Wang, Andrew Head, **Ashley Ge Zhang**, Steve Oney, Christopher Brooks (2023) Colaroid: A Literate Programming Approach for Authoring Explorable Multi-Stage Tutorials. *ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)*, Hamburg, Germany. **Honorable Mention Award**

J.2 (PDF) **Ashley Ge Zhang***, Mike Merrill*, Yang Liu, Jeffrey Heer, Tim Althoff (2022) CORAL: COde RepresentAtion Learning with Weakly-Supervised Transformers for Analyzing Data Analysis. *European Physical Journal Data Science (EPJ)*.

C.1 Mike Merrill, **Ashley Ge Zhang**, Tim Althoff (2021) Mining Collective Data Science
(PDF) Knowledge from Code on the Web to Suggest Alternative Data Analysis Approaches. *ACM Conference on Knowledge Discovery and Data Mining (KDD)*, Singapore.

Refereed Posters (P), Workshops (W), and Doctoral Consortiums (D)

P.5 **Ashley Ge Zhang**, Yan-Ru Jhou, Yinuo Yang, Shamita Rao, Maryam Arab, Yan Chen,
to appear Steve Oney (2026) Editrail: Understanding AI Usage by Visualizing Student-AI Interaction in Code. *Demo at ACM Symposium on User Interface Software and Technology (UIST)*, Detroit, MI, USA.

D.4 **Ashley Ge Zhang** (2025) Scaling Code Understanding for Introductory Programming
(PDF) in the AI Era. *Online Doctoral Consortium at ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)*, Yokohama, Japan.

W.3 **Ashley Ge Zhang**, Yinuo Yang, Maryam Arab, Yan Chen, Steve Oney (2025) Un-
(PDF) derstanding And Guiding Student-AI Interaction In Future Programming Education. *Workshop at ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)*, Yokohama, Japan.

P.2 **Ashley Ge Zhang**, Xiaohang Tang, Steve Oney, Yan Chen (2024) Demonstration
(PDF) of CFlow: Supporting Semantic Flow Analysis of Students' Code in Programming Problems at Scale. *Demo at ACM Conference on Learning at Scale (L@S)*, Atlanta, GA.

P.1 Shiyu Xu, **Ashley Ge Zhang**, Steve Oney (2023) How Pairing by Code Similarity
(PDF) Influences Discussions in Peer Learning. *Late Breaking Work at ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)*, Hamburg, Germany.

Awards

2026 **Rising Stars in Data Science by University of Chicago**

2026 **Special Recognitions for Outstanding Reviews, UIST**

2026 **Special Recognitions for Outstanding Reviews, CHI**

2021 – 2026 **University of Michigan School of Information's Travel Grant**

2022 – 2026 **University of Michigan Rackham Conference Travel Grant**

2025 **Best Paper Honorable Mention Award, VL/HCC**
SPARK: Real-Time Monitoring of Multi-Faceted Programming Exercises (C.7)

2024 **Best Paper Award, L@S**
CFlow: Supporting Semantic Flow Analysis of Students' Code in Programming Problems at Scale (C.6)

2024 **Special Recognitions for Outstanding Reviews, CHI**

2023 **Best Paper Honorable Mention Award, CHI**
VizProg: Identifying Misunderstandings by Visualizing Students' Coding Progress (C.4)

2023 **Best Paper Honorable Mention Award, CHI**
Colaroid: A Literate Programming Approach for Authoring Explorable Multi-Stage Tutorials (C.3)

2019 **People's Choice Award, Google Girls' Hackathon**
Leading a team of 5 undergraduate students to develop a game app.

2017 **2nd Prize of ACM Competition, Peking University**

Invited Talks

10/2026 **University of Maine**
Orono, ME Making Learning Visible in the Age of AI: Interactive Systems for Understanding and Supporting Programming Education

Service

Program Committee

2026 ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI), Poster

2025 ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI), Late Breaking Work

Peer Reviewing

2026 – 2027 ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)

2024 – 2026 ACM Symposium on User Interface Software and Technology (UIST)

2026 ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI), Poster

2025 IEEE Symposium on Visual Languages and Human-Centric Computing (VL/HCC), Poster

2025 ACM Conference on Creativity and Cognition (C&C)

2025 ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI), Late Breaking Work

2023 – 2024 ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)

2023 – 2024 ACM Conference on Computer-Supported Cooperative Work and Social Computing (CSCW)

2022 – 2023 ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI), Late Breaking Work

2022 The Journal of Computer Languages (COLA)

2022 IEEE Symposium on Visual Languages and Human-Centric Computing (VL/HCC)

Operations Committee

2023 ACM CHI student volunteer

Teaching

Winter 2026 **Graduate Student Instructor – SI 201 (Data-Oriented Programming)**
University of Michigan

Fall 2025 **Graduate Student Instructor – SI 201 (Data-Oriented Programming)**
University of Michigan

Fall 2024 **Graduate Student Instructor – SI 579 (Building Interactive Applications)**
University of Michigan

Mentoring

Mentees

2025 **Shamita Rao**
University of Michigan Master student, School of Information

2024 – 2025 **Yinuo Yang**
University of Michigan Undergraduate Student
Next position: PhD student at the University of Notre Dame

2024 **Zhixuan Chen**
University of Michigan Master Student, Computer Science and Engineering
Next position: Software Developer Engineer at Amazon

2021 **Shiyu Xu**
University of Michigan Master Student, School of Information
Next position: PhD student at the University of Michigan